



Lunenburg Public Schools FY21 Recommended Budget Presentation

DR. KATE BURNHAM, SUPERINTENDENT

LUNENBURG PUBLIC SCHOOLS

PRESENTED APRIL 29, 2020

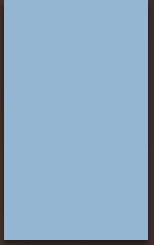
PUBLIC HEARING ON BUDGET

Mission

The Mission of the Lunenburg Public Schools is to provide all students with the skills, confidence, and passion for life-long learning so that they may find their own paths to successful careers, active citizenship, and rewarding lives.

Vision

The Lunenburg Public Schools is committed to becoming a leader in education by focusing on its values of attending to the personal well-being of its students, providing high-quality curricula and student-centered instruction for deeper learning at all levels, and promoting the development of attributes and skills necessary for continuous learning for all.



The Budget Priorities

Develop a budget that meets student needs and aligns with the Strategy for Continuous Improvement objectives.

The Budget Process

AUGUST & SEPTEMBER

District Leadership Team worked to develop the Strategy for Continuous Improvement, and align School Improvement Plan goals, administrator and teacher evaluation goals to the Strategy objectives.

OCTOBER

Instructional Leadership Team began to develop a 5-year staffing plan that would support student needs and execute the Strategy for Continuous Improvement. Department leaders and building administrators developed FY21 budget requests focused on highest impact on teaching and learning and alignment with Strategy objectives. Superintendent presented trends in population/student needs data at the Symposium Oct 29, 2019.

NOVEMBER

Budgets were submitted to the Superintendent. Individual meetings were held with each department head and building administrator to review budget line requests. Leadership Teams continued to refine the 5-Year Staffing Plan.

DECEMBER

The 5-Year Staffing Plan was finalized and submitted to the Town Manager and was incorporated into the 5-year financial forecast presented in January. The 5-Year Staffing Plan was presented to the School Committee as Identified Needs.

The Budget Process

JANUARY

The Leadership Team prioritized the Year-1 positions and identified those deemed most critical for inclusion in a student need-based budget proposal. The Proposed FY21 Budget was presented to the School Committee on January 22, 2020.

FEBRUARY

The budget was adjusted for actual health insurance increases. Three possible scenarios were presented to School Committee on February 26th ; 3.24%, 2.9%, 2.5%.

MARCH

The three budget scenarios were presented in detail on March 11th. The School Committee endorsed the 3.24% budget and agreed all three scenarios should be presented to the Finance Committee on March 12th. The Superintendent closed all schools effective March 16th due to COVID-19. All Massachusetts schools were closed by the Governor effective March 17th. The public hearing on the school department budget scheduled for March 18th was cancelled, as were all town meetings that week, due to COVID-19.

APRIL

Town Manager requested a level service budget with no new positions. A level service budget with 2 critical teaching positions was submitted. (1.58%). Public hearing on budget rescheduled for April 29th. Annual Town Meeting rescheduled for June 13th.

COVID-19 does not eliminate or change:

- ▶ State mandates
- ▶ Our shifting demographic: socioeconomic, ethnic, racial
- ▶ Increasing enrollment
- ▶ Our projected staffing needs
- ▶ Our student needs: academic, social-emotional, behavioral

COVID-19 creates new challenges:

Under remote learning ensuring:

- ▶ our students are fed
- ▶ our students can equitably access remote learning: internet access, computers for each student
- ▶ training for teachers in instructional technology
- ▶ quality teaching in a virtual classroom
- ▶ delivery of special education services
- ▶ behavioral health supports for students, families & staff

Opening schools with physical distancing:

- ▶ Transporting students
- ▶ Serving lunch
- ▶ Classrooms with desks 6 feet apart
- ▶ Passing between classes
- ▶ Recess

Lingering impacts:

- ▶ Will staff and students feel that it is safe to return?

Proposed FY21 Budget

presented Jan. 22, 2020; SC endorsed March 11, 2020

- ▶ Assistant Principal
- ▶ Full-time Psychologist
- ▶ Sped Teacher- THES
- ▶ Building Leadership stipends
- ▶ Expense lines for each school as requested

3.24%

	FY20 Budget	FY21 Budget	
TOTAL SALARIES:	14,407,125	15,305,885	6.24%
TOTAL EXPENSES:	6,388,738	6,164,446	-3.51%
TOTAL BUDGET:	20,795,863	21,470,331	3.24%

Recommended FY21 Budget

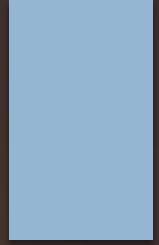
as a result of the economic impact due to COVID-19

- ▶ Sped Teacher- THES
- ▶ Wilson/Orton-Gillingham Reading Teacher
- ▶ Increase in unemployment (up to \$75,000)
- ▶ \$30K Salary reserve (down from \$322K)

1.58%

	FY20 Budget	FY21 Budget	
TOTAL SALARIES:	14,407,125	14,910,125	3.49%
TOTAL EXPENSES:	6,388,738	6,213,477	-2.74%
TOTAL BUDGET:	20,795,863	21,123,602	1.58%

Recommended FY21 School Department Budget Summary



FY20 Department Budget	\$ 20,795,863
Cost of Level Services for Staffing	350,048
New Positions	122,952
Salary Reserve	30,000
Expense Reduction	(175,261)
Total Proposed FY21 Budget	\$ 21,123,602

What are we losing as compared to the 3.24% budget proposal?

- ▶ Assistant Principal
- ▶ School Psychologist
- ▶ Salary Reserve reduction for contractual negotiations

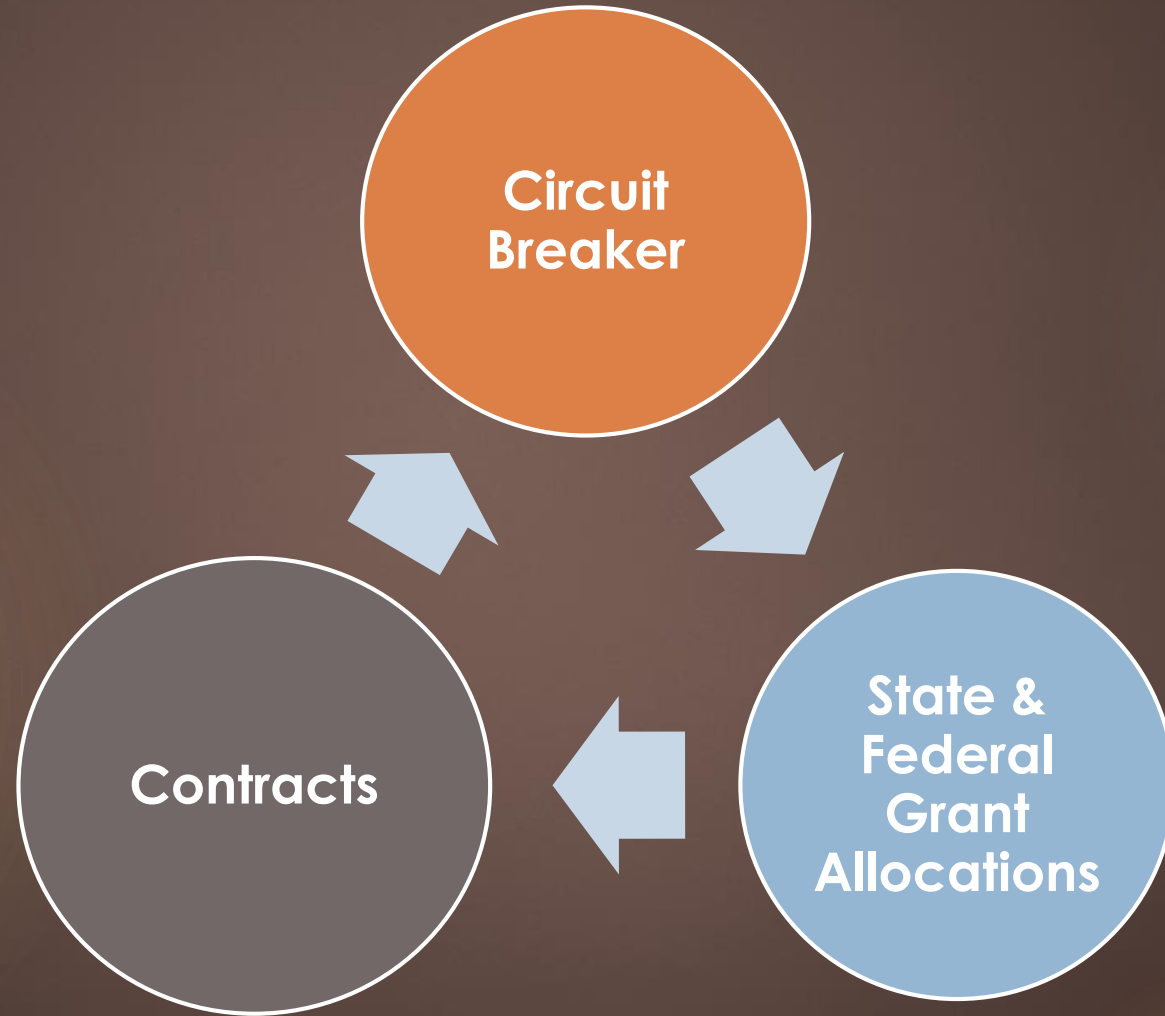
What is the impact of this reduction?

Budget Priorities:

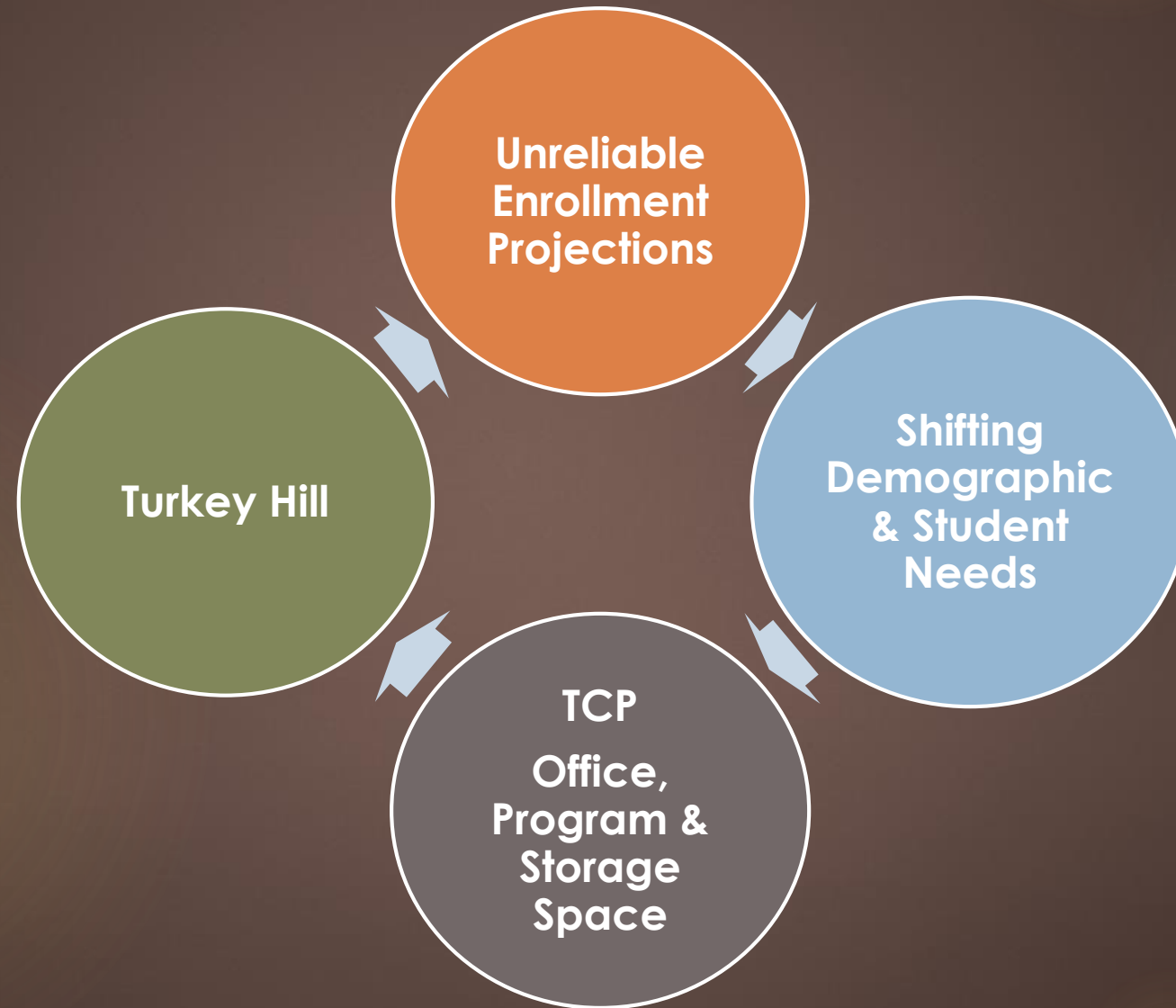
Our capacity to optimally meet the needs of all students is diminished.

Progress on the execution of the Strategy for Continuous Improvement will be significantly slowed.

Budgetary Unknowns



Future Unknowns





As the Town of Lunenburg continues to see growth and demographic changes, level service budgets will not allow the district to continue to perform at or above the state in terms of student achievement and growth. We need to invest in the operational budget of the schools to ensure that we can continue to meet our students' needs.



Questions?